ABOUT THIS TOOL

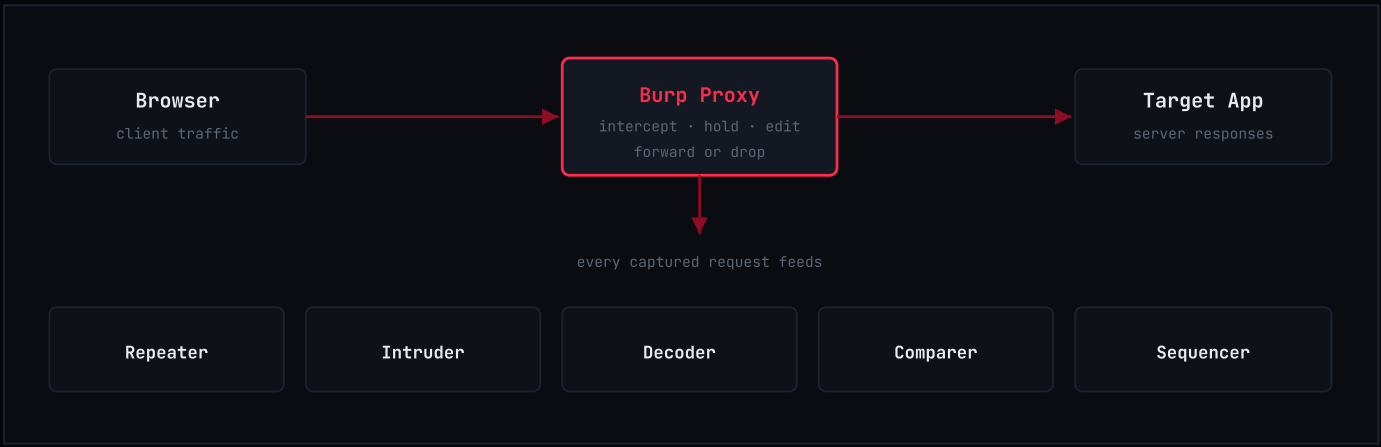
Burp Suite — Field Guide & Quick Reference

Burp Suite (PortSwigger) is the intercepting-proxy platform almost every web application engagement runs through. The core idea is simple: it sits between your browser and the target application, so every request and response passes through it first — which means you can inspect, hold, edit and replay traffic the application never expected a human to touch directly.

Everything else in Burp exists to make that one capability useful. Proxy captures and lets you intercept live traffic. Repeater lets you take a single request and manually poke at it, over and over, until you understand exactly how the server reacts. Intruder automates that poking across large payload sets. Decoder, Comparer and Sequencer are utilities for the fiddly parts — encoding, diffing, and checking whether a token is actually random.

The diagram below is the mental model worth keeping: one proxy, one place traffic flows through, several tools that all draw from the same captured requests. The reference pages that follow are organised the same way — by which tool you're in, not by vulnerability class.

One honesty note: Burp ships as Community (free) and Professional (paid) editions. Everything covered here works in Community. The active vulnerability Scanner and a faster Intruder attack engine are Professional-only and are deliberately left out — this is a reference for the tools you'll actually be clicking, not a pitch for the license.



One proxy in the middle of everything. Every tool downstream works from requests that passed through it.

QUICK REFERENCE

1. Proxy & Interception

Intercept is on/off — pause traffic before it reaches the target so you can inspect or edit it `Proxy › Intercept`

Forward — release the held request or response on to its destination `Forward button`

Drop — discard the intercepted item entirely, nothing is sent `Drop button`

HTTP history — a running log of every request that has passed through the proxy `Proxy › HTTP history`

Intercept Client Requests rules — control which requests actually get held for review `Proxy › Options`

Match and Replace — auto-rewrite specific headers or values on every request `Proxy › Options`

Intercept Server Responses — hold responses too, not just outbound requests `Proxy › Options`

2. Repeater

Send to Repeater — load the current request in for manual, repeated editing `Ctrl+R`

Send — fire the request currently loaded in this tab `Ctrl+Space`

New tab — keep multiple requests open side by side for comparison `+ button`

Render — view an HTML response rendered, not just as raw text `Render tab`

Follow redirects — control whether Repeater automatically chases 3xx responses `gear icon`

Update Content-Length — keeps a modified body's header honest automatically `on by default`

3. Intruder

Send to Intruder — load the current request in for automated payload testing `Ctrl+I`

Positions — mark exactly where payloads get inserted with § markers `Positions tab`

Sniper — one payload set, cycled through each position one at a time `Attack type`

Battering ram — the same payload inserted into every position at once `Attack type`

Pitchfork — multiple payload sets, marched together position by position `Attack type`

Cluster bomb — multiple payload sets, every combination between them tried `Attack type`

Grep - Match — flag any response that contains a specific string `Options tab`

4. Target, Scope & Site Map

Site map — a tree of everything Burp has passively observed so far `Target › Site map`

Add to scope — mark a host as in-scope from the site map `right-click`

Scope settings — define what's actually in play, by URL or host pattern `Target › Scope`

Show only in-scope items — filter the site map down to what matters `filter bar`

Engagement tools — Search, Compare site maps, Discover content `right-click`

Issue definitions — Burp's own reference for what each finding means `Target › Issue definitions`

5. Decoder

Encode as — URL, HTML, Base64, ASCII hex and more `dropdown`

Decode as — the reverse of the same transform list `dropdown`

Smart decode — auto-detect the likely encoding and decode it `Smart decode`

Hash — compute MD5 / SHA-1 / SHA-256 and others on the current data `Hash dropdown`

Chain transforms — stack multiple encode/decode passes, each building on the last `add row`

6. Comparer

Send to Comparer — load two items in from anywhere to diff them `right-click`

Compare words — diff the two items at the word level `Words button`

Compare bytes — diff the two items at the byte level `Bytes button`

Sync scroll — keep both panes aligned while reviewing a long diff `on by default`

7. Sequencer

Live capture — feed Sequencer live proxy traffic to analyse as it arrives `Live capture tab`

Manual load — paste in a set of tokens — session IDs, CSRF tokens — to test `Paste tab`

Analyze now — run the randomness/entropy analysis on the captured set `Analyze Now`

Character-level analysis — see exactly where predictability creeps into a token `results tab`

8. Extensions & BApp Store

BApp Store — Burp's built-in extension marketplace `Extensions › BApp Store`

Logger++ — richer, filterable request/response logging than the default `BApp Store`

Autorize — automated authorization testing across user roles `BApp Store`

Turbo Intruder — scriptable, high-throughput alternative to stock Intruder `BApp Store`

Param Miner — finds hidden or unlinked parameters and headers `BApp Store`

JSON Web Tokens — inspect and tamper with JWTs in place `BApp Store`

9. Shortcuts & Workflow

Send to Repeater — the fastest way to start manually probing a request `Ctrl+R`

Send to Intruder — the fastest way to start an automated payload run `Ctrl+I`

Send (in Repeater) — fire whatever request is currently loaded `Ctrl+Space`

Find in view — search within whatever panel currently has focus `Ctrl+F`

Right-click › Send to — the same destinations, no shortcut needed `context menu`

> **Scope reminder:** *Everything here assumes you're pointed at scope you're actually authorised to test — Burp makes it trivially easy to hammer an endpoint that isn't yours.*